

Assignment1 - portfolio
SEG3125

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2026.5.24

Previous experience in JavaScript development, and what you did as tutorial videos/readings to acquire the necessary skills to do the current project.

My experience with Javascript is relatively limited before this class. To have the special typing effect for this project, I combined self-directed research with modern development workflows. I learn from W3Schools and online video tutorials to handle the basic grammar and structure, while utilizing AI tools to narrow down specific code functions (like `setTimeout()`) for the efficiency to achieve an idea.

Provide links to at least 3 portfolio sites that have inspired you, either positively (liked) or negatively (disliked). Explain why they inspired you in one way or another.

<https://www.notyourtype.nl/typefaces/>

Impact: primarily positive

Analysis: This portfolio is highly effective due to its minimalist and highly functional design, which prioritizes user experience while maintaining a strong aesthetic identity. Because the core purpose of the site is to showcase typography, the decision to use a stark, monochromatic background featuring hand-drawn elements is brilliant. This stylistic choice avoids unnecessary noise and establishes the typefaces themselves as the central design elements.

However, from a user experience perspective, the site suffers from a lack of intuitive guidance. The layout is abstract, occasionally breaking standard usability rules. Without clear signs or navigational clues, users can feel disoriented, proving that visual creativity must always be balanced with functional accessibility.

<https://ivydeng.com/>

Impact: Positive

Analysis: This site serves as an excellent case study in how dynamic interactions can help. I was particularly touched by the interactive main section, where the stellar background dynamically rotates in response to the user's cursor movements. This creates an immersive, engaging user experience from the moment the page loads.

Inspired by this seamless integration of motion design, I adapted the concept of real-time feedback into my own portfolio. Instead of replicating the spatial movement, I translated the interactive feel into a text effect on my About Me section, making the content appear as though it is being actively typed out in real time.

<https://artoflaziness.cargo.site/>

Impact: Positive

Analysis: This portfolio shows a master level synthesis of art direction and digital design. What makes this site exceptional is its structural integrity, it flawlessly unifies aesthetic elements with intentional interactive design. Rather than relying on superficial animations, every interactive component feels deeply integrated into the site's overall conceptual theme.

Encountering this site inspired me to think outside conventional grid layouts and pushed me to present my own creative work through a more experimental, narrative-driven lens.

Link to my source code

<https://github.com/Qinglan12/SEG3125-project/tree/main>

A description of your design choices in relation to visual communication:**a. Colors****i. What palette did you choose and why?**

The color palette was intentionally selected to establish a strong connection with the primary artwork featured on the homepage. I used gray for the Hello World title, and a dark crimson color for the four case studies. This strategy utilizes the principle of simultaneous contrast, surrounding saturated colors with neutral grays exaggerates their visual effect, drawing immediate focus to the case studies and the core artwork.

To ensure the interface feels cohesive rather than stark, the background behind the artwork features a warm, low-opacity light yellow tint. On the other hand, the About Me sidebar utilizes a highly saturated pink. This high-saturation choice guarantees visibility and acts as a visual echo of the decorative point elements within the main illustration.

b. Typography**i. What fonts did you choose and why?**

The typography mainly rely on two fonts from open-source repositories, and it's free for personal use. For the primary Hello World title, I utilized the LEDlight typeface. Its digital, structured geometry immediately evokes a technological aesthetic, aligning the portfolio with a modern, digital art context.

For the About Me body text and secondary texts, I selected Punk Typewriter. This font choice introduces a raw, tactile contrast to the clean lines of the LED headings. The slight variances in its letterforms, paired with its underlying drop shadows, introduce structural texture into the interface, preventing the layout from too plain and simple.

c. Screen Layout

i. Describe your layout and how it incorporates the principles of Scale, Visual Hierarchy, Balance and Contrast (see NN/g videos)

The interface layout relies on a structured, three-column composition designed to guide the user's eye naturally across the screen. The central canvas has the primary illustration, which is scaled significantly larger than any other element. This variation in scale establishes an undeniable focal point, demonstrating the visual hierarchy. The user's journey begins here before moving out to the supporting textual content.

The layout has a dynamic, asymmetrical balance through the distribution of visual weight. The left column (the About Me section) uses high color saturation to balance the scale and color of the central artwork.

On the right column, the four case studies create a vertical rhythm that corresponds to the central piece. This creates a harmony between the monochromatic grays and the highly saturated elements; the high contrast ensures that four navigational images remain clear and easily discoverable without competing against the main artwork.